

Figure 5: FreeNAS after reboot

BitTorrent, iTunes, CIFS (via Samba), etc. It provides plug-ins for SlimServer and XBox Media Stream Protocol. In the legacy version, Unison support is available. An iSCSI target feature is available to create virtual disks. ZFS, UFS, ext2 and ext3 are supported. Read and write for FAT32 and NTFS are supported. It has dynamic DNS clients for DynDNS, ZoneEdit, No-Ip, and *freedns.afraid.org*. The hard drives supported are {P,S} ATA, SCSI, iSCSI, USB and FireWire; booting is possible from HDD, CD-ROMs, floppy disks, or USB flash drives. All wired and wireless network cards and hardware RAID cards supported by FreeBSD work well with FreeNAS. Other than that, S.M.A.R.T., VLAN, link fail-over interfaces, link aggregation and UPS systems are also supported.

Installation in a VM

I assume you have created (using VMWare Workstation, Player or other virtualisation software) a virtual machine having 512 MB of RAM, a 20 GB virtual HDD, 1 processor (I created this on a physical machine with an Intel Pentium Dual CPU t2370 @ 1.73 GHz, 2 GB of RAM, a 160 GB HDD and a 32-bit OS). Attach the FreeNAS ISO downloaded from SourceForge and start the VM. From the FreeNAS 8.3.0-Release Console Setup, select *Install/Upgrade*. Next, select the drive where you want to install FreeNAS. If a USB drive is attached, it will be available once it is software-disconnected from the physical host (see Figure 3). After this, a warning will be displayed (Figure 4) before proceeding with the installation. A pre-installation summary is displayed while installation is in progress, which should be followed by a message informing you that FreeNAS installation succeeded, and asking you to reboot. Reboot the virtual machine.

Figure 5 shows the boot messages after the reboot; note the IP address, and use it in the browser's address bar to access the Web interface. A 'CRITICAL Alert' is displayed when you first access the FreeNAS UI; you have to change the password for the *admin* user (at first, no password is required to log in). Click *Account -> Change Password*. Groups and user management can also be done

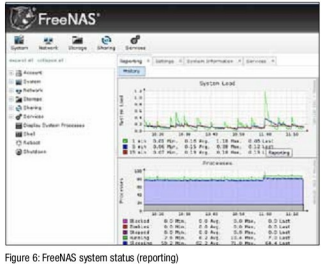


Figure 6: FreeNAS system status (reporting)

from *Account*. The *Storage* tab is an important part of FreeNAS configuration. Figure 6 shows the system status (the *Reporting* tab).

New features

FreeNAS 8.3.0 provides snapshot support, de-duplication, a removable log device, as well as support for Areca 13xx SAS controllers. It also has graphs with improvements for navigation to different points in time; the capability to redirect from *http://* to *https://* when accessing the administrative GUI and SSL is enabled; improved replication tasks and encrypted FTP connections; the availability of a memory device while GUI up-gradation is performed; Active Directory configurations with verbose logging; the ability to modify the serial port speed; non-root NFS mounts, and the ability to specify an address for pools (NFS, ZFS) with the auto-expand property configured. END

References

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